

Email (SMTP) — Setup Guide

The app sends email through **plain SMTP** — no third-party API, no vendor account. Works with Gmail, Google Workspace, your web host's mail server, Zoho, Fastmail, or an internal relay.

Sending happens in the Supabase Edge Function `dispatch-notifications`, so the credentials live in **Supabase secrets**, never in the web app.

The one setting people get wrong

`SMTP_PORT` and `SMTP_SECURE` must agree:

Port	SMTP_SECURE	Why
465	true	Implicit TLS — the connection is encrypted from the first byte.
587	false	Plaintext connect, then upgraded via STARTTLS.

Setting `secure: true` on port 587 (or `false` on 465) produces a connection that **hangs and then times out** with no useful error. If sending is silently timing out, check this first.

Use 465 where you can. Some hosts throttle or block 587.

Gmail / Google Workspace

Gmail requires an **App Password** — your normal account password will not work, and OAuth is overkill here.

1. **Enable 2-Step Verification.** myaccount.google.com → **Security** → **2-Step Verification**. App Passwords do not exist without it.
2. Go to **Security** → search settings for **App passwords** (or myaccount.google.com/apppasswords).
3. Create one named `Aurum Ops`. Copy the **16-character** password — Google shows it once.
4. Set the secrets:

Paste the App Password **without spaces**. Google displays it as `abcd efgh ijkl mnop`; the spaces are for readability only.

Gmail limits

	Recipients/day	Recipients per message
Free Gmail	500	100
Google Workspace	2,000	100

Exceeding them gets outgoing mail blocked for up to 24 hours. This app sends a handful of alerts a day, so you are nowhere near — but it's a hard ceiling if you ever move to customer-facing mail.

`SMTP_FROM` must be the same account as `SMTP_USER` (or a verified alias). Gmail rewrites mismatched From headers, which hurts deliverability.

Other providers

Same variables, different values:

Zoho

```
SMTP_HOST=smtp.zoho.in    SMTP_PORT=465    SMTP_SECURE=true
```

Microsoft 365 (no 465 support — must use 587)

```
SMTP_HOST=smtp.office365.com    SMTP_PORT=587    SMTP_SECURE=false
```

Typical cPanel / shared host

```
SMTP_HOST=mail.yourdomain.com    SMTP_PORT=465    SMTP_SECURE=true
```

Who receives the alerts

Two sources, combined:

1. **Every approved Accountant** — automatic, from `app_users`. They're the verification desk, so they always get a copy, and it self-heals as staff change.
2. **Anyone in `notification_recipients`:**

```
insert into public.notification_recipients (label, channel, destination,
events)
values ('Ops inbox', 'EMAIL', 'ops@yourdomain.com',
       '{BOOKING_SUBMITTED,PAYMENT_ADDED}');
```

There's also an env fallback (`OPS_ALERT_EMAILS` in `.env.local`) used only while that table is empty — for bootstrapping.

Verify it works

1. **Dry run first.** With `INTEGRATIONS_DRY_RUN=true`, nothing is sent and rows are recorded as `SKIPPED` — never `SENT` — so a dry run is always distinguishable from a real delivery.

```
npx supabase secrets set INTEGRATIONS_DRY_RUN=true
```

Create a booking, then:

```
select channel, status, provider, recipient, error_code, error_message
from public.notification_deliveries order by created_at desc limit 10;
```

Expect **SKIPPED** / **noop**. **If you get no rows at all, the problem is enqueue, not email** — check the web app's server logs.

2. Go live.

```
npx supabase secrets set INTEGRATIONS_DRY_RUN=false
```

Create another booking. Expect **SENT** / **smtp**.

3. Watch the logs.

```
npx supabase functions logs dispatch-notifications
```

Errors you'll actually hit

Recorded in `notification_deliveries.error_code`. The worker stops retrying terminal errors and backs off transient ones (1m → 5m → 30m).

Code	Meaning	Fix
<code>SMTP_AUTH</code>	Rejected credentials	Wrong App Password, or 2-Step Verification was turned off (which silently invalidates every App Password). Regenerate.
<code>ETIMEDOUT</code> / <code>ESOCKET</code>	Connection never established	Almost always the port/secure mismatch above.
<code>EDNS</code> / <code>ENOTFOUND</code>	Hostname doesn't resolve	Typo in <code>SMTP_HOST</code> .
<code>550</code> / <code>553</code>	Recipient rejected	Bad address, or the From domain isn't allowed to send.
<code>454</code> / <code>421</code>	Throttled	Transient — retries handle it. Persistent means you hit the daily cap.

Deliverability

Mail from a plain Gmail account to internal colleagues is fine. If it starts landing in spam, or you later send to people outside the company, publish DNS records for your sending domain:

- **SPF** — authorises the sending server
- **DKIM** — signs the message
- **DMARC** — tells receivers what to do on failure

Google Workspace generates DKIM for you in Admin Console → Apps → Gmail → Authenticate email. A plain [@gmail.com](#) account can't be DKIM-signed for your own domain — that's the point at which a dedicated transactional provider starts to earn its keep.